William Portfolio — Setup & Hosting Guide

This guide covers everything you need to run, edit, and host your portfolio. Two options are provided: publishing directly from Manus (no local setup required), or self-hosting via GitHub and GitHub Pages — no third-party services beyond GitHub are required.

Option A — Publish from Manus (Easiest)

Since the project is already running inside Manus, this is the fastest way to go live.

1. Open the Manus Management UI panel (top-right of the interface)
2. Click the **Publish** button in the header
3. Your portfolio is immediately live at a public URL (e.g. `william.manus.space`)
4. To connect a custom domain (e.g. `williamportfolio.com`), go to **Settings → Domains** in the panel
5. To update content later, request changes in the Manus chat — edits are applied and republished with one click

> ***Recommended if:*** *You want to go live immediately without any local tooling.*

Option B — Self-Host via GitHub + GitHub Pages (Full Ownership)

This approach gives you complete ownership of the code, the ability to edit it locally, and free hosting — all through a single service (GitHub). No Vercel or other third-party accounts are needed.

Step 1 — Install Prerequisites

Install the following tools on your machine (one-time setup):

Tool	Purpose	Download
Node.js (v18 or later)	JavaScript runtime required to run the project	nodejs.org
pnpm	Package manager (faster than npm)	Run `npm install -g pnpm` in terminal after installing Node.js
Git	Version control for pushing code to GitHub	git-scm.com
VS Code (recommended)	Code editor for modifying content	code.visualstudio.com

To verify everything is installed correctly, open a terminal and run:

```
node --version    # should print v18.x.x or higher
pnpm --version    # should print a version number
git --version     # should print a version number
```

Step 2 — Run the Portfolio Locally

1. Extract the `william-portfolio.zip` file
2. Open a terminal and navigate into the extracted folder:

```
cd william-portfolio
```

1. Install dependencies (first time only — this may take a minute):

```
pnpm install
```

1. Start the local development server:

```
pnpm dev
```

1. Open your browser and go to **`http://localhost:3000`**

The portfolio is now running locally. Any changes you save to the code will update in the browser automatically. To stop the server, press `Ctrl + C` in the terminal.

Step 3 — Configure the Project for GitHub Pages

GitHub Pages serves your site from a subfolder by default (e.g. `https://username.github.io/william-portfolio/`). You need to tell Vite about this base path so all assets load correctly.

Open `vite.config.ts` in VS Code and add the `base` option:

```
export default defineConfig({
  base: '/william-portfolio/',   // ← add this line (must match your repo name exactly)
  // ... rest of your existing config
});
```

> ***Note:*** *If you name your GitHub repository something other than `william-portfolio`, use that name here instead.*
>
> ***Exception:*** *If you name your repository `YOUR-USERNAME.github.io` (replacing `YOUR-USERNAME` with your actual GitHub username), GitHub Pages will serve it at the root URL with no subfolder. In that case, set `base: '/'` instead.*

Step 4 — Push Your Code to GitHub

1. Create a free account at github.com if you do not have one
2. Create a new repository at github.com/new:
   - Name it `william-portfolio` (or `YOUR-USERNAME.github.io` for a root URL)
   - Set it to **Public** (GitHub Pages requires public repos on the free plan)

- Do **not** initialise it with a README

3. In your terminal (inside the `william-portfolio` folder), run:

```
git init
git add .
git commit -m "Initial portfolio"
git branch -M main
git remote add origin https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/william-portfolio.git
git push -u origin main
```

Replace `YOUR-USERNAME` with your GitHub username.

Step 5 — Deploy to GitHub Pages

GitHub Pages can be configured to automatically build and deploy your site whenever you push code.

1. Go to your repository on GitHub
2. Click **Settings** → **Pages** (in the left sidebar)
3. Under **Build and deployment**, set the **Source** to **GitHub Actions**
4. Create the following file in your project at `.github/workflows/deploy.yml`:

```yaml
name: Deploy to GitHub Pages

on:
  push:
    branches: [main]

jobs:
  build-and-deploy:
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest
    permissions:
      contents: read
      pages: write
      id-token: write
    environment:
      name: github-pages
      url: ${{ steps.deployment.outputs.page_url }}
    steps:
      - uses: actions/checkout@v4

      - name: Install pnpm
        uses: pnpm/action-setup@v3
        with:
          version: 10

      - name: Install Node.js
        uses: actions/setup-node@v4
        with:
          node-version: 20
          cache: pnpm

      - name: Install dependencies
        run: pnpm install

      - name: Build
        run: pnpm build

      - name: Upload artifact
        uses: actions/upload-pages-artifact@v3
        with:
          path: dist/public

      - name: Deploy to GitHub Pages
        id: deployment
        uses: actions/deploy-pages@v4
```

1. Commit and push this file:

```
git add .github/workflows/deploy.yml
git commit -m "Add GitHub Pages deployment workflow"
git push
```

1. Go to the **Actions** tab in your GitHub repository — you will see the deployment running. It takes about 60–90 seconds.
2. Once complete, your portfolio is live at: `https://YOUR-USERNAME.github.io/william-portfolio/`

Step 6 — Updating Content Later

All portfolio content lives in the `client/src/components/sections/` folder. Open any of the files below in VS Code to make changes:

What to update	File to edit
Name, tagline, hero bio	`HeroSection.tsx`
Scramble role titles	`HeroSection.tsx` → `SCRAMBLE_TITLES` array at the top
About text and stats (years, projects, etc.)	`AboutSection.tsx`
Work experience entries	`ExperienceSection.tsx`
Skills and proficiency levels	`SkillsSection.tsx`
Interests / hobbies	`InterestsSection.tsx`
Contact email and social links	`ContactSection.tsx`

Workflow for every update:

```
# 1. Make your edits in VS Code
# 2. Preview locally
pnpm dev

# 3. When happy, commit and push
git add .
git commit -m "Update bio and experience"
git push
```

GitHub Actions will automatically detect the push, rebuild the site, and redeploy it — usually within 60–90 seconds.

Optional — Custom Domain

If you purchase a domain (e.g. `williamportfolio.com`, typically $10–15/year from Namecheap or Porkbun):

1. Go to your repository → **Settings → Pages**
2. Enter your domain under **Custom domain** and click Save
3. Follow the DNS instructions GitHub provides (you will add a CNAME record at your domain registrar)
4. GitHub will automatically provision a free HTTPS certificate

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Cost Summary

Service	Cost
Node.js, pnpm, Git, VS Code	Free
GitHub (account + repository)	Free
GitHub Pages hosting	Free
Custom domain (optional)	$10–15/year

Archived Shaders

Three alternative background shaders are included in the project. To switch between them, replace the contents of `client/src/components/ShaderCanvas.tsx` with the contents of the desired archived file:

Shader	File
Neural Web (current)	`ShaderCanvas.tsx`
Marble Liquid	`ShaderCanvas.MarbleLiquid.tsx`
Iridescent Ribbons	`ShaderCanvas.IridescentRibbons.tsx`

Quick Reference

```
william-portfolio/
├── .github/
│   └── workflows/
│       └── deploy.yml          ← GitHub Pages auto-deploy workflow
├── client/
│   ├── index.html              ← Page title and font imports
│   └── src/
│       ├── components/
│       │   ├── sections/       ← ALL CONTENT LIVES HERE
│       │   ├── ShaderCanvas.tsx
│       │   ├── ScrambleText.tsx
│       │   ├── CustomCursor.tsx
│       │   ├── TopNav.tsx
│       │   └── NavDots.tsx
│       ├── lib/
│       │   └── theme-tokens.ts ← Colour palette (dark + light mode)
│       └── index.css           ← Global styles and CSS variables
├── vite.config.ts              ← Add base: '/william-portfolio/' here
├── package.json
└── pnpm-lock.yaml
```

Generated by Manus — March 2026